

# Project Reflection

## Project: Customer Support Ticket Intent Classification

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### 1. Introduction

This project marked the beginning of my AI Data Annotation portfolio. The objective was not only to complete an intent classification task but also to develop a structured annotation workflow that reflects industry practices. Throughout the project, I focused on applying annotation guidelines consistently, reviewing ambiguous cases carefully, and documenting the complete annotation process.

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### 2. What I Learned

Working through this project helped me understand that effective data annotation requires more than assigning labels.

Key lessons included:

- The importance of following annotation guidelines consistently.
  - Distinguishing between similar intent categories using context rather than keywords.
  - Recognizing that customer messages can contain multiple intents, which would require careful identification of the primary intent.
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### 3. Challenges Encountered

Several customer messages contained overlapping intents, making label selection less straightforward.

Examples included:

- Technical problems that resulted in billing concerns.
- Account-related issues involving verification failures.
- Messages describing multiple problems within a single request.

These cases required careful interpretation of the customer's primary intent before assigning a final label.

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### 4. How the Challenges Were Addressed

To improve consistency, I adopted the following approach:

- Reviewed the annotation guidelines before revisiting ambiguous cases.
- Prioritized the customer's primary intent always.
- Documented reasons for my decisions using annotation notes.
- Applied QA feedback to ensure consistent labeling across the dataset.

This process helped strengthen the overall quality of the final annotations.

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## 5. Skills Developed

Completing this project strengthened my ability to:

- Perform text classification tasks.
  - Apply annotation guidelines consistently.
  - Identify ambiguous cases.
  - Conduct annotation quality assurance.
  - Document annotation decisions clearly.
  - Maintain organized project documentation.
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## 6. Areas for Improvement

If this project were expanded in the future, I would:

- Increase the dataset size to improve label diversity.
  - Introduce confidence scores for difficult classifications.
  - Develop more detailed guidance for handling edge cases.
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## 7. Personal Reflection

Beyond improving my technical skills, this project also strengthened my confidence in approaching annotation projects methodically and presenting my work in a professional manner. Before starting this project, I assumed data annotation was simply assigning labels to text. But working through a couple of samples I can really appreciate how small changes in interpretation can affect the quality of a dataset.

This experience has prepared me to take on more advanced annotation tasks while continuing to build a portfolio that demonstrates practical work with excellent quality. This project serves as the foundation for future portfolio projects involving sentiment analysis, named entity recognition, content moderation, and LLM response evaluation.